Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Third Month, 2026

Monthly Query: *As I learn from others, how do I give freely from what I have gained?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *If you feel moved to speak in meeting for worship, take a moment to test your message. Is it from the Inward Light? Is it meant only for me, or for the entire Meeting?*

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Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom** • After meeting - **Potluck in the schoolhouse**
Second Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom**
Third Sunday	• 8:00 - 9:00 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** (reverts to 8:15 the following week) • 9:00 - 10:30 am - **Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom**
Fourth Sunday	• Same as Second Sunday - **Blended Meeting**
Fifth Sunday	• Same as First Sunday, but without potluck

Upcoming Zoom Fora

https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html

March 1: Max and June Carter on Palestine
They will be joining us in a forum sponsored by P&J to talk about their experiences

March 8: Alejandra Solemi on the public health functions of religious communities.

March 15: Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (no forum)

March 22: Wayne Finegar: Quaker House, A Place of Peace in a Military City

March 29: TBD

Upcoming Events

Piedmont Friends March Events

MARCH 2026 – Piedmont Friends Events

Book Club on the History of Black Labor, Feb. 26 - Mar. 19

Lloyd Kramer shares with Friends:

I'm writing to share a message from Danita Mason-Hogans of the Bridging the Gap. We have supported the work of this group through the Alternate Gift Mart and other forms of support. Danita is launching a book discussion group this coming week, focusing on Black communities and Black Labor. And she would like to invite members of our Meeting community to participate. You do not have to read the books to attend, though the books will provide the themes for discussion. The invitation and schedule are below.

> Dear Quaker Friends,
>
> I am incredibly grateful for you. Each time I see you at an event, you feel like family.

I want to invite you to join us on **Thursday, February 26** as we begin this year's Community History Read and Conversation Series. We are reading Black Folk by Dr. Blair Kelley and centering the history of Black labor — especially the local laborers and organizers who sustained Chapel Hill.

Session Dates:
Feb 26 – Black Labor Histories: Local Lineages of Struggle
March 5 – Black Folk with Dr. Blair Kelley
March 12 – Resistance, Mutual Aid & Collective Power
March 19 – Imagining the Future of Black Labor in Chapel Hill

All sessions at Chapel Hill Public Library, Meeting Room B
Doors open 5:30 (food & fellowship) | Artist performance 6:00
Reservation not required - Just show up

Your support feels hopeful to me. It feels rooted in our shared value of love, liberation, and a belief in humanity's future. When University funding fell away this year, your generosity made a way.

This is more than a book club. It is remembrance. It is narrative justice. It is calling our ancestors into the room and saying — we see you.

I hope you'll join us.

In Community,
Danita

39th Annual Powwow - Fanning the Flame, Mar. 7, 10am - 6pm

Carolyn White shares with Friends:

As a follow up to our retreat of February 21 on Quakers and Native Americans, Vivette Jeffies-Logan sent information about the Pow Wow at UNC **March 7** and a PDF about the 4 R's (relationship, responsibility, reciprocity and redistribution.)

Contact: unccicpowwow@gmail.com

The Remembrance Coalition Invites You, Sat. Mar. 21, 1 pm

Dottie Heninger shares with Friends:

On March 21 at 1pm at Mt. Bright Baptist Church, 211 W. Union St., Hillsborough, Dr. Freddie Parker will be in discussion with Sylvester Allen Jr. and Belle Boggs, the authors of The Legend Of Wyatt Outlaw. Coincidentally, it was on this date in 1870 that Wyatt Outlaw was lynched.

Quaker House Forum and Annual Report, March 22

Curt Torell shares with Friends:

Wayne Finegar, Quaker House Executive Director, will present the CHFM forum on March 22, via zoom. Tune in to hear the latest news from the Homefront including the spike in calls to the GI Rights Hotline from military members faced with dilemmas of following illegal orders and domestic deployments, while adhering to the U.S. Constitution and their oath of service. Other updates about Quaker House are in the annual report in the Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business February's minutes.

Virtual Power of Enough Workshop, begins April 1

Traci Hjelt Sullivan shares with Friends:

How can I balance my use of time, energy, money, and “things,” to free myself to contribute to-right order in our world? The Power of Enough workshop invites participants through queries and experiential exercises to approach these aspects of our lives, as individuals and as a community. Five 90-minutes sessions. Read more and register for this Right Sharing of World Resources workshop

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Piedmont Friends Retreat & Annual Sessions, June 5, 6, 7

Piedmont Friends will be meeting for the 2026 Retreat & Annual Sessions at Haw River State Park, June 5, 6, 7.

As we prepare for this expanded gathering, we are inviting all Piedmont Friends meetings to participate in the planning and to recommend a Friend from their meeting to serve on the Retreat Planning Committee.

The Committee will meet periodically on Zoom to plan for

- Retreat theme, focus and queries
- Adult, Youth and Young Adult Programming
- Accommodations and meal arrangements with Haw River State Park
- Coordinate with the Clerking Committee the Annual Sessions

- Retreat flyer, communications, registration

Information about the Retreat and Haw River State Park, including some pictures from an initial site-visit, is available on our website at:
https://www.piedmontfriends.org/2026-retreat-annual-sessions/

Announcements

Follow up on the Reproductive Healthcare Symposium

Wendy Michener shares with Friends:

Sign our Petition on Change.org - NC's Reproductive Healthcare Crisis: Mis-Directed Funding. Use this link Petition · NC's Reproductive Healthcare Crisis: Mis-Directed Funding - United States · Change.org. Share the petition with other NC Residents. Of note, making a donation to Change.org and / or signing other petitions is not a requirement.

"Preconceived" documentary is a 2024 expose' about the harmful deceptive and shady business practices of these organizations. There are reportedly about 100 of them in NC and they reportedly will receive $21 million for 2025-2026 from the State of NC, with no oversight whatever. Available Streaming includes Amazon Prime for $2.74, and $3.99 on You Tube and Google Play. Trailer is Preconceived.

The Symposium lectures were recorded but it is 3 hours - it will be cut up into manageable lengths. Scholars/Scientists should contact Wendy Michener for permission to get the entire tape.

No ICE in Cary — Durham Resistance

Walter Hjelt Sullivan shares with Friends:

Friends,
The link to sign up to support the campaign to oppose the develop a new ICE office in Cary, NC:

https://durhamresistance.com/noiceincary

In friendship,
Walter

Apply now for AFSC's Emerging Leaders for Liberation program

Whitney Fry shares with Friends:

AFSC implements an 8-month leadership program for young adults (ages 18-22) who long to strengthen their social justice and community organization skills. Participants learn skills from AFSC staff and develop their own social change action project. Participants also engage with Quakerism and Quaker history through workshops that connect Quaker values to peace and justice work. AFSC is accepting applications now through March 8th; interested applicants can learn more here and submit an application here.

AFSC Update on Shadi Khoury

Whitney Fry shares with Friends:

On January 20th, Israeli courts sentenced Shadi Khouri, a minor, to four years in prison. Shadi was a graduate of Ramallah Friends School, and more about his story can be read here. AFSC has been in close contact with Shadi's mother about this case, in addition to others affected by child imprisonment. AFSC, in partnership with Defense for Children International, works to improve the situation for children affected by Israeli's military court and detention system through the No Way to Treat a Child Campaign (NWTTAC).

CFS Beloved Community Offerings this Coming Spring

Pam Schwingl shares with Friends:
From Carolina Friends School Beloved Community Institute:

UPCOMING WELLNESS AND TRANSFORMATIONAL TRAVEL-LEARNING PROGRAMS
Registration opens soon!

- **Coastal Journey**, a six-day racial justice trip to Savannah and Charleston. **Early March 2026**
- **Quaker Journey**, a weeklong visit to the 17th-century roots of Quakerism in the breathtaking Lake District of Northern England. **2-9 August 2026**

You can see links for these and additional offerings at www.cfsnc.org/AdultEnrichment.

Recurring Announcements

InterFath Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Carolyn White.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions: zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).

Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm

You are invited to join Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine and Israel at 5:30 p.m. ET / 2:30 p.m. PT.

Join on Zoom:
https://afsc-org.zoom.us/j/85831333364?pwd=VEtPTUZuYk5hTHV2OGs1VzRkY0ZKUT09
Meeting ID: 858 3133 3364
Passcode: 759311

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. “A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom.”
https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence “You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below.”

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)
Join Zoom Meeting
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09
Meeting ID: 416 500 5614
Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.

Business Meeting Minutes

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting, **Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business**
Minutes, February 15, 2026, online via Zoom

Present: Jeff Brown, Jennifer Leeman, Deborah Gibbs, Hart Pillow, Quaker Harmon, Tom Ludlow, Ben Ousley, Carolyn White, Tom Munk, Matt Drake, Dottie Heninger, John Hite, Rob Jones, Curt Torell, Allie Scales, Nancy Milio, Marion Schoenbach, Monteze Snyder, Astra Titus, Melissa Ruof, David Waterman, Kevin Smith, Whitney Fry, Lloyd Kramer, Kate Fitch, Buzz Borchardt, Carolyn Stuart, Walter Sullivan, Julia Cleaver, Jan Hutton, Wendy Michener, Alice Carlton, Margaret Vimmerstedt, Betsy Brinson, Ann Miller, Herb Derby

1. We opened with worship and the query, "How am I following Jesus' example of love in action?"

One Friend suggested that Jesus exemplified radical love in action. Jesus was willing to speak truth to power and to do so in a way that could cost him his life. The Friend noted that he lacks courage, and struggles because he is only part way there.

2. We welcomed Whitney Fry as a first-time attender to Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.

3. Friends approved the minutes of the January 2026 Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.

4. Curt Torell presented the annual report of the Quaker House Board (Appendix A). The report includes a report from the Director of Quaker House followed by a supplement from the Friends who represent our Meeting on the board. Friends noted the impressive way that Lenore and Steve have lived out their values in all aspects of their lives, including working on the GI Hotline for the past 25 years. Another Friend spoke to the importance of supporting communities that stand against authoritarianism and the value of what Quaker House does, which has national significance. Friends accepted the report with great appreciation.

5. Rob Jones presented the Children and Youth Religious Education Committee Annual Report (Appendix B). A Friend invited others to serve as First Day School teachers. A second Friend noted the importance of this committee's work to the future of the Meeting. Friends accepted the report with gratitude for the committee.

6. The Clerk presented a proposal to appoint a Chapel Hill Friends Meeting liaison to the American Friends Service Committee (AFSC) and to appoint Whitney Fry to serve as the liaison (Appendix C). A Friend noted that we have had a yearly meeting appointee to the Friends Committee on National Legislation (FCNL) versus one from our Meeting. Are we considering also have a Meeting representative to FCNL? And, is there a yearly Meeting appointee to AFSC?

This question relates, in part, to whether our Meeting or the yearly meeting would fund travel to meetings. Note was made that Peace & Justice has some funds for travel to FCNL; should that nomey be available also for AFSC meetings? Friends noted that Whitney has been serving as our representative to AFSC informally and affirmed her serving in this role, with enthusiasm. We deferred a decision to allow for further seasoning on appointments to FCNL and AFSC. What is the appointment process within the meeting and formal relationships to the organizations? How will travel to meetings be funded?

7. On behalf of the Peace & Justice Committee, Tom Munk presented the recommendation to endorse the statement "Quaker organizations discern genocide is occurring in Gaza and urge courageous action" as posted by the American Friends Service Committee on their website: https://afsc.org/newsroom/quaker-organizations-discern-genocide-occurring-gaza-and-urge-courageous-action

Tom described the process through which this statement has been considered up to this point, including a recent forum and discernment with concerned Friends at a meeting of the Peace & Justice Committee. Based on input from Friends, the recommendation is to include the following statement along with our indorsement in the "Is There Anything You Would Like Us to Know" box of the signing form.

"We are grateful to our Quaker Organizations for this statement of truth and responsibility. Had we written the statement, we would not have included the word anti-Zionism, which is not well-defined. Additionally, we would have added mention of the environmental destruction that has accompanied this genocide. There is no peace for humans if there is no peace for our planet."

Friends noted appreciation for Tom Munk, the Peace and Justice Committee, and others shepherding this through multiple steps to bring this forward. Friends approved the recommendation to endorse the statement, with the additional text to be included in the signing form. In coordination with Tom, Jeff Brown, as Clerk, will sign the endorsement on behalf of the meeting. The suggestion was made to also notify our yearly meeting of our endorsement..

8. The next Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business is planned for 9:00 AM on March 15, 2026.

9. We closed with worship.

Jeff Brown, Clerk, and Jennifer Leeman, Recording Clerk

Appendix A: Quaker House 2026 Annual Report

Quaker
HOUSE

223 Hillside Avenue, Fayetteville, NC 28301 910-323-3912
execdirector@quakerhouse.org quakerhouse.org

While Quaker House continues to fulfill its mission to aid military participants and their families in addressing the injuries caused by the military-industrial complex, the past year has brought new challenges and opportunities.

It was clear that the new presidential administration was dedicated to reversing many of the improvements that had been made in the nation's military. In the early months of 2025, Quaker House published articles and reports focusing on the efforts of Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth to remove women and people of color from military leadership. Many of these can be found on the Quaker House website at quakerhouse.org/blog-2/.

At the beginning of summer, Lenore and Steve, our GI Rights Counselors, and the GI Rights Hotline experienced a surge in contacts immediately following the federalization of the California National Guard. Information about the Hotline was being shared across social media and many people reached out to express support, to verify the phone number, and to seek counseling because their involvement in the National Guard wasn't intended to include helping arrest their neighbors. While the unsustainably high contact volume fell after a few weeks, the Hotline continued to see increased numbers as the administration sought additional federalizations and deployments of troops to cities across the country. As Lenore and Steve begin their 25th year of working for Quaker House, we have been fortunate to have Kelly join the GI Rights Counseling team this fall.

From the first days of the administration, Quaker House and allied groups recognized that the issue of illegal orders would arise. Led by the Military Lawyers Task Force of the National Lawyers Guild, which is a member of the leadership of the GI Rights Hotline, this group produced a new FAQ on illegal orders and what rights members of the military have to refuse to obey these orders. It was released just as the federalization of troops began in the summer and the issue has only continued to rise in prominence. By early 2026 it has reached the point where Quaker House Director Wayne Finegar has been invited to present information on the subject to multiple Friends' gatherings. We anticipate that it will only continue to grow in relevance as more questionable efforts are made by the administration.

The Quaker House Counseling Service continues to meet the needs of people in the Fayetteville, North Carolina area trying to deal with issues related to domestic violence, substance abuse, moral injury, and other damage caused by their involvement with the military. We have been able to provide services for everyone who has been referred to the Counseling Service and are seeking options to expand our geographic range. Counselor Joanna has become licensed in

Virginia and is seeking admission to South Carolina. We also continue to offer advice and insight to communities in other states who are interested in forming a counseling service in their area.

Quaker House is looking for ways to expand our outreach and visibility as the need for our services continues to become more acute. In addition to adding Kelly to the GI Rights counseling team, we have introduced a new twice monthly channel called *Reconnaissance*. Built on the Substack platform, it allows Quaker House to present longer form articles and reports looking at the state of the military and the ongoing challenges faced by military participants. Board Member Curt Torell completed his massive update to our book *Conscientious Objection: Is This for You?* last summer and an associated PowerPoint. We are looking at sponsoring a podcast episode with Thee Quaker and have entered into a joint contract with the GI Rights Hotline to develop the social media presence of both organizations.

Quaker House continues to be very fortunate to receive generous support from people, both Quakers and others, across the country. In 2025 we received donations from 372 individuals and households, 78 local worshiping communities, and 5 yearly meetings. Even with the increased costs for everything, Quaker House remains financially stable.

It is only with continued support that we will be able to continue to have that strength, and the new efforts we are investing in will include new expenses as well. More contacts to the GI Rights Hotline will mean we will need more counselors, more clients for the Counseling Service may require more social workers to meet their needs, and more outreach will include new costs. We know that the need for our work is only going to grow in the coming years and rely on everyone's support to be able to meet those needs.

In the Light,

Wayne Finegar

Executive Director

Addendum to Wayne's Report by CHFM board members Rufus King, Lori Kamala, and Curt Torell

As the meeting's representatives to the Quaker House board, we are pleased with the organization's strength, the staff it has, and leadership Wayne provides. He has a firm grasp on its mission and has adapted to changing times. His report does not mention the many personal visits he is making to Quaker communities both within the state and nationally which is building a wide committed base.

As noted, this year marks the 25th Anniversary of Steve and Lenore's service as Quaker House GI Rights Hotline counselors. They have been a background of the national Hotline, navigating its many transformations over the years and themselves answering over 60,000 calls. Those cases

included 14% who were AWOL, 10% who had Delayed Entry or erroneous enlistment questions, 8% with conscientious objections claims, and the rest covering over a hundred different reasons including, medical and psychological discharges, pregnancy or family issues, entry level separations, misconduct, drug or alcohol difficulties, benefit or upgrade claims, legal assistance, courts marital matters, and other grievances or denial of rights. In every case, Steve and Lenore listen to the caller with openness and empathy. Twenty-five years ago in their first report to the Quaker House board, they summarized the response to their work:

A number of people of told us how much they appreciated speaking with us, even in cases where our role has been more to listen than to give information. In such instances, the hotline becomes empowering for servicemembers who otherwise don't have sympathetic people to listen to them and who are often blamed for their failure to adapt to an unhealthy military lifestyle. Often members feel humiliated by their failure.

Closer to this Meeting, Quaker House published a second, revamped version of the *Conscientious Objection: Is This for You?* curriculum that sprang from the work and devotion of this meeting over 25 years ago. Quaker House board member Curt Torell, who also serves on the Quaker Religious Education Collaborative Steering Circle (which is essentially an outgrowth of the old FGE RE committee), traveled to New England in August to the NEYM and then in November, along with Beth Collea from QREC, to several New England states to make presentations and new contacts about this work. This was also a good opportunity to introduce Quaker House to a new region.

As Wayne mentioned in his report, we are grateful to the support, financially and otherwise, from this Meeting towards the mission of Quaker House.

Submitted,

CHFM board members Rufus King, Lori Khamala, and Curt Torell

Mission: *Quaker House is a manifestation of the Religious Society of Friends' Peace Testimony. Based in Fayetteville, NC, the home of Ft. Bragg, Quaker House provides counseling and support to service members who are questioning their role in the military; educates them, their families, and the public about military issues; and advocates for a more peaceful world.*

Appendix B: Children's and Youth Religious Education Annual Report

February 2025-February 2026

The Children's and Youth Religious Education (CYRE) Committee is responsible for the development, oversight, and support of curricula and activities for young Friends in preschool through high school. CYRE is also responsible for childcare in the nursery. In addition to supporting the First Day School (FDS) program and two paid staff positions (FDS Coordinator and Childcare Provider), the committee recruits teachers, selects materials, assesses progress, clarifies goals and objectives, oversees a budget, and communicates with the Ministry and Worship Committee. In summary, the CYRE Committee nurtures the spiritual development of children and teens and their families, and works to integrate families and young Friends into the life of the meeting. For the past year, we have been holding FDS in the multi-purpose room in the schoolhouse as well as one of the classrooms in the schoolhouse. In the meetinghouse, we have used the nursery and the teen room. We have continued to meet as a committee using Google Meet.

After a year of co-clerking, Rob Jones continued on as sole clerk of CYRE this year. We did not have any new committee members. Continuing members are: Kara GrawOzburn, Tom Munk, and Leslie Rountree. Stacey Sewall (Childcare Provider) and Kathleen McNeil (FDS Coordinator) serve on the committee as ex-officio members.

First Day School (FDS) program

We have continued to have participation from families with children ranging in age from infant to high school during the last year. Attendance has remained steady year, and we have continued with the multipod system with Nursery, Lower, Middle and Teen Pods meeting separately as numbers allow. The nursery opens at 10:55 AM, and First Day School starts at 11:15.

The Lower Pod has been meeting in the three-fours classroom. Children range in age from three to seven. The teachers include Leslie Rountree, Jennifer Leeman, Stacey Sewall, Gwynne Pomeroy, and Carolyn Stuart. There have been between one and six in attendance each week. The Middle Pod continues to convene in the multi-purpose room. Children have ranged in age from eight to fourteen. The teachers have included Kathleen McNeil, Mark Hulbert, and Cecilia King. There has been attendance of somewhere between one and eight each week. The Upper Pod has generally consisted of highschoolers. The teachers have been John Hite, Tom Munk, and Rob Jones. The teens led the whole FDS to organize the alternative gift mart. They raised $7,405.00 dollars for benevolences. The teens also helped coordinate parking during home UNC Football games and one soccer exhibition game which raised $10,325.00. Additionally, Tom Munk led the FDS students in games once a month.

The curriculum is composed of four parts:

Bible Studies (January through Easter) which alternates between the Old Testament and the New Testament. In 2025, students studied the New Testament. In 2026 the students are engaging with the Old Testament culminating with Old Testament Field Day.

Multicultural Unit; (Sunday after Easter through the end of the school year) We learned about traditions in Judaism, Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, and a variety of indigenous people's traditions. In June we had an excellent visit to the Hindu temple in Cary.

Quakerism (late August until Sunday before Thanksgiving). Students studied Quaker history, testimonies and practices.

Holiday Activities (Sunday after Thanksgiving through the first Sunday in January). Carolyn Stuart led young Friends in creating cards for Quakers at Carol Woods who are not regular meeting attendees, and for men at Orange Correctional Center who worship with us. They also made ornaments with Leslie Rountree, performed a nativity play, and made bird feeders to welcome the New Year. Additionally, the teens hosted peers from the Durham Friends Meeting for a white elephant gift exchange with John Hite, Tom Munk, and Lori Khamala.

Nursery Care

Nursery care has been provided by Stacey Sewall. She also assists with curriculum planning as well as working with little ones on the playground as necessary.

Participation in the Larger Meeting

FDS led a gratitude forum the week of Thanksgiving. FDS partners with Tom Munk for intergenerational board game fun after potluck on the first First Day of each month. FDS children eagerly contributed to potlucks and celebrations by assisting with setting up.

Collaboration with Friends outside of our Meeting

We visited the Durham Friends Meeting in October as part of our Quakerism unit. In January, we had a great visit from some Durham Friends teens as mentioned above.

Building Family Connections

FDS held two family gatherings at Mark Hulburt's home outdoors: one in spring and one in fall.

Teen Activities

The teens coordinated The Alternative Gift Mart. The CHFM teens are also partnering with Durham Friends Meeting teens for joint activities. Conscientious Objector curriculum has been impeccably and thoroughly developed by Curt Torell to be used with support from John Hite for interested teens.

Looking Forward

We are delighted to have had the continued participation of approximately ten families in FDS activities and a stable group of teachers during the past year. Additionally, we are thrilled to have welcomed several new families into our program. We look forward to renewing our connections

in the coming year and continuing to build closer relationships among our meeting families as we integrate the children into the life of the meeting as a whole.

Respectfully submitted by the CYRE committee: Rob Jones (clerk), Kathleen McNeil (FDS Coordinator, ex-officio), Stacey Sewall (Childcare Provider, ex-officio), Leslie Rountree, Tom Munk, and Kara GrawOzburn

Appendix C: Proposal to Appoint a CHFM Liaison to AFSC

One of our Meeting's legacy benevolence recipients is the American Friends Service Committee. Naveed Moeed and Betsy Brinson have informed CHFM about AFSC in recent years. We do not have an appointed liaison to renew a connection to AFSC, and this is not a position that is subject to the Nominations Committee.

As your Meeting Clerk, I propose that CHFM appoint a liaison to connect the Meeting with AFSC. With the intention to be practical in expectations while renewing our longtime connection to AFSC, I understand the duties of a CHFM liaison include the following.

- Prepare and present an annual report about AFSC to Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business. The content would include the previous year's highlights of CHFM liaison activities with AFSC, priority programs of AFSC, and facts that lend insight into the condition of AFSC nationally.
- Attend quarterly online meetings with the AFSC Liaison for Friends Meetings.
- Offer brief monthly updates for the CHFM newsletter.
- When opportune, propose a Forum to the Adult Religious Education Committee to inform CHFM of current AFSC concerns and activities.
- There may be other opportunities to serve as a connection between CHFM and AFSC, as the liaison is led.

I recommend appointment of Whitney Fry to serve as liaison to AFSC to keep CHFM informed and connected to the organization. Whitney has participated in liaison meetings and is conversant with AFSC programs and activities. I propose a two-year appointment, renewable for up to 6 years.